gross cropped area to net cropped area is only around 1.5. Gross cropped area can be increased to twice that of net cropped area with better management. Further, productivity of agriculture can also be raised significantly. The government should actively take up the policy of transferring about 10–15 million hectares of agricultural land to non-agricultural use—preferably the marginal agricultural lands. This will bring down excessively high land prices for residential, factory and infrastructure projects to reasonable levels.

The government should also bring about a transformation of land use within the agriculture field. Land productivity of horticulture is much more than field crops. Output of foodgrain crops has also risen to a reasonably comfortable level whereas demand is not growing that fast. On the other hand, demand for horticultural crops is increasing impressively. Land productivity is the highest in case of animal husbandry and demand for animal husbandry products is also witnessing good growth. Thus, there is good reason to shift part of the land from foodgrain crops to horticultural and animal husbandry products. The shifting of land *inter se* in agriculture will not hurt foodgrains as there is enormous scope to increase productivity of foodgrain crops as well.

Replace Input Subsidy Programmes with Direct Cash Support for Farmers

The green revolution was built on popularization of agriculture inputs: seeds, fertilizers, insecticides, agriculture equipment, electricity and so on. To provide farmers these subsidized inputs, subsidized farm loans were also provided. These more productive inputs helped India transform from being a food-deficit country to a food exporter. The efficacy of input subsidization is now over. Farmers have learnt the advantage of using high-yielding seeds, fertilizers, farm equipment and other inputs. In fact, there is evidence of overuse of these inputs on account of their being highly subsidized.